

This article is intended to provide readers with a general understanding of health-care issues rather than provide personalized medical, financial, or legal advice. Please consult your physician. — **Julie Rains**



6 Secrets for Nailing That Salon Manicure Look

A 10-finger discount? My painted nails redefine that term in a fashion that transcends all crimes. Without theft or fraud, I score big savings with my manicured hands.

Here's how: With art and artifice, my hands have a fraudulent appearance of expensive weekly spa dates. Through careful maintenance and

do-it-yourself enamel, I have created a polished 10-finger discount.

CAREFUL MAINTENANCE

The first approach—careful maintenance—is valuable for extending the lifespan of salon or DIY nail color. With discipline and maintenance, I have stretched manicures for two to three weeks longer than the standard one week of brittle color. To do so, I follow these steps:

1. Let the paint dry

Meditate, breathe deeply, or count to 1,000. The goal: Keep your mind active and your hands still. This Zen approach to nail polish will preserve the finish of your painted nails. That's because nothing fades faster than smudged, nicked, or dented nails. So get your money's worth from a professional manicure by taking the time to let the paint completely dry.

2. Wear a top coat

A glaze of clear nail polish will serve as an invisible barrier between your manicure and the world. Coated by a clear top coat, your painted nails will remain bright and chip-free. Clear